

Sencha Touch: This is used to create mobile apps for several platforms including iOS, BlackBerry and Android. It is one of the first HTML5 frameworks for mobile devices. It provides a native look and feel across platforms, with a comprehensive UI widget library and touch event management with CSS transitions.

SproutCore: This is an original JavaScript MVC library, which is built on top of JavaScript. It can also be used in native apps, which run on Android, BlackBerry or iOS by using PhoneGap (an open source mobile app development framework for hybrid apps).

JQT (JQTouch): This is a JQuery plugin, which consists of animation, automatic navigation and different themes for WebKit browsers. It uses HTML, CSS and JavaScript to give the experience of a native app.

Viziapps: Viziapps makes it easy to develop an application with the drag-and-drop feature. It is an online application platform. A user can also access backend data. One need not be a coder to use Viziapps.

HTML5 vs native applications

As we know, native apps are based on the native language; hence, each platform would have its own app. And some platforms would support different versions of the app. Whereas, once HTML5 apps are developed, they can run on many platforms and it is easier to maintain a single code base. This makes these apps less expensive than native apps. They can deliver bug fixes and updates without much trouble as they avoid distribution. They also perform live testing.

In spite of all these advantages, HTML5 in mobile devices has its shortcomings. The implementation varies from browser to browser and from one mobile platform to another. The animation, graphics, etc, do not perform as well

as native apps under certain conditions. HTML5 apps often work erratically in the absence of a data connection. They do not have a secure storage and do not support background processing. HTML apps cannot compete with native apps when it comes to multi-touch gestures, GPS, etc.

But these aren't the only choices we have. We have hybrid apps, which have all aspects of native code and reusable HTML5 runs on top of them. These apps emulate and have the look and feel of a native app. One of the most frequently used frameworks for hybrid app development is PhoneGap. It enables wrapping up of CSS, HTML and JavaScript code, depending upon the platform of the device.

The road ahead

Both native and HTML5 apps have their own pros and cons. Presently, the market for native apps is larger than the market for HTML5 apps. The impact made by the introduction of HTML5 apps has been revolutionary. Now, what will persist in the future depends on business requirements, developer preferences and technological advances. Hybrid apps have a top-notch future. As the browsers move towards extending support to HTML5, the future of these apps looks very bright. 

References

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August 2016	Network Monitoring
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October 2016	Cloud Special
November 2016	Open Source on Windows
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